was in touch with his roots, represented the real India and was in permanent combat with an out-of-touch elite was one that Modi had perfected in the 2002 Gujarat riots. In this discourse of outsiders versus original inheritors, every abuse hurled at Modi ended up making him stronger.

There is no doubt that Narendra Modi brings a premium to the BJP. We now have the data to substantiate how and when that shift in perspective began. The party speaks about Modi more than it speaks about anyone else (see Figures 6.1 and 6.2). If 2014 was a personality contest, 2019 was a personality contest on steroids.

The numbers on the Narad Index clearly illustrate this shift. In 2014, even though Modi was its face and electrified the campaign, the BJP spoke much less about him than it would do later. The Index shows that it spoke twice more about itself (0.657) than it did about Modi (0.325) that year, when it was a party challenging the in-power UPA. By 2019, the BJP was significantly more dependent on Brand Modi. In five years, the velocity of the party's Modi-speak doubled (0.661), so much so that it was now talking more about Modi than it was about itself (0.649).

Figure 6.5: How Modi-Speak Changed on the Narad Index (2005–2019)

